

1673



Marquette and Jolliet descend the Mississippi River with their guides.

THE EXTENSIVE WATERWAYS

OF North America provided a ready-made means of exploring its interior. In 1673, French-Canadian explorer Louis Jolliet and French Jesuit Jacques Marquette traveled down the Mississippi River to within 370 miles (600 km) of the Gulf of Mexico. They turned back for fear of arousing Spanish hostility but discovered the Missouri

and Ohio rivers, as well as confirming that the river led to the Gulf and not the Pacific. English exploration inland from their scattered coastal settlements was much more hesitant, rarely coordinated, and additionally blocked by the Appalachian mountain chain. It almost always depended on native assistance. For example, it was after spending a year with a group of Tomahitan Indians in present-day Georgia that Gabriel Arthur traveled with them across the Cumberland Gap, unwittingly discovering what in the 18th century would be the principal route to Kentucky and the west.

2,000 MILES, THE LENGTH OF THE APPALACHIAN MOUNTAINS

1674



Ceremonial entrance of the Qing emperor, Kangxi, to Beijing. Kangxi oversaw the complete suppression of the Three Feudatories revolt.

FOLLOWING THEIR TAKEOVER OF CHINA WITH THE COLLAPSE

of the Ming dynasty in 1644, the Qing coopted some of the more powerful Ming generals, making them regional governors and allowing them considerable latitude in their rule over what became almost independent territories. It was felt that if they enriched themselves—as they did on a prodigious scale—the less likely it was that they would revolt. The risk was that their progressively greater revenues would be matched by greater pretensions to rule China. In 1674, the Revolt of the Three Feudatories broke out across southern China in those provinces controlled by the three most prominent rebels, Wu Sangui, Shang Kexi Gungdong, and Geng Jingzhong, joined by lesser Ming governors. Led by the Kangxi Emperor (1654–1722), the Qing response, with its superior military, was successful,

albeit not until 1681. With the rebels as wary of each other as they were of the Qing, they rarely cooperated, allowing the Qing to pick them off one by one. Those rebels who did not commit suicide were executed.

After freeing the Hindu Maratha from the Sultan of Bijapur, Shivaji (1630–80) was crowned Maratha king in 1674, establishing the

Maratha Empire (see p.242) that would later defeat the Mughals to dominate India until the early 19th century.



Statue of Shivaji

This bronze statue of Shivaji on horseback in Maharashtra, India, commemorates his leadership of the Maratha campaign for self-rule.

1675



Frederick William I leads his troops at the Battle of Fehrbellin.

IN 1675, MUGHAL EMPEROR AURANGZEB ORDERED THE

EXECUTION of Togh Bahadur, ninth guru of the Sikhs, after he had refused to convert to Islam. It brought to the Sikh throne his nine-year-old son, **Gobind Singh** (1666–1708). It would be several years later that, under Singh's leadership, the Sikhs would pose a growing **military threat to Mughal rule**, and contribute significantly to its collapse. However, the pattern of **religious opposition to the Mughals** was already well

established in many parts of India, most obviously in the Western Ghats, where Shivaji had declared the Maratha Empire.

On June 18, 1675, a combined Prussian and Brandenburg army, led by Frederick William I, Elector of Brandenburg (1620–88), met and **defeated a Swedish army**, led by Count von Wrangel, near **Fehrbellin**, in Brandenburg. This relatively insignificant battle in the **Scanian War**, itself a by-product of the Franco-Dutch War, nonetheless marked a crucial moment in Sweden's long struggle to impose itself as the dominant Baltic power. Defeat at the hands of an otherwise relatively minor German state **dealt the Swedes a lasting blow**. Swedish pretensions to great power status were revealed as precarious at best.

Leibniz mechanical calculator

One of the first calculating machines, developed by Gottfried Leibniz, this device multiplies by making repeated additions.

In 1671, German mathematician **Gottfried Leibniz** (1646–1716) demonstrated one of the **world's first mechanical calculators**. It was the first such machine that could perform all four of the basic arithmetic functions. Leibniz went on to further refine his calculating machines, thus providing the basis of the modern calculator.

Repeated **Cossack and Crimean Tartar revolts** against the weakened Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth in 1672 drew their Ottoman allies into a four-year **Polish-Ottoman War**. Polish resistance under Jan III Sobieski (1629–96) was greatly undermined by grudging support from the Polish parliament, the Sejm, and was hardly equal to the progressively larger armies of the Ottomans. The result was the **loss of what little prestige Poland could still claim** as well as most of its Ukrainian territories.

April 1672 Franco-Dutch War begins with invasion of Dutch Republic (to 1678)
July 4, 1672 William III of Orange appointed Stadtholder of Holland
June 7, 1672 Battle of Solebay in Third Anglo-Dutch War is inconclusive
October 18, 1672 Treaty of Buczacz between Ottoman Empire and Polish-Lithuania Commonwealth

February 17 French writer and actor Molière dies (b. 1622)
May Jolliet and Marquette begin exploration of Mississippi River
English explorer Gabriel Arthur crosses Appalachians
Battles of Schooneveld between English and Dutch fleets

Revolt of the Three Feudatories breaks out in China
February 19 Treaty of Westminster ends Third Anglo-Dutch War
June 6 Shivaji declares Hindu Maratha Empire
August 11 Battle of Seneffe sees French defeat Dutch-Spanish-Austrian army
November 10 New Netherland (including New Amsterdam), in North America, ceded to England
May 21 Jan III Sobieski elected king of Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth
Pondicherry, south India, becomes base of French East India Company
November 8 English poet John Milton dies (b. 1608)

Sikh leader, Togh Bahadur, executed by Mughals
June 18 Battle of Fehrbellin sees Brandenburg and Prussia defeat Sweden
Development of haiku poetry, Japan
War between English colonists and Algonquian American Indian tribes